

Abby

It is her bar, even when she is out of the frame.



The proprietor with the last word

SPECIES

West Highland terrier

AGE

Mid-forties

PERSONALITY

- Warm, quick-witted and entirely in command
- Elegant and feminine, without a frightening or exaggerated expression
- An attentive proprietor whose welcome has standards

She settles the absurdity from behind the bar.

Background & place in the story

Abby owns The Swinging Door and works its bar. She is the proprietor, not background scenery or somebody else's employee. The welcome, the standards and the rhythm of the room are hers. She is fond of the gentlemen, values their conversation and is intimidated by neither of them.

While Drew notices the mechanism and Barclay considers the bill, Abby keeps a real business running. That practical viewpoint gives her the authority to close the conversation with one warm, decisive line. She need not appear in every cartoon for the room to feel like hers; when she joins the exchange, her contribution matters.

Current portrait: 1024 x 1536 pixels, placed at approximately 287 PPI. No upscaling.

Signature details.

The small things that make this character unmistakable.



The studded collar and teardrop

One even row of rounded studs, a front buckle and one teardrop pendant. This is her signature accessory; the retired pearl-necklace design is not the current Abby.



One empty glass, one plain towel

Her current work action is polishing an empty wine glass. One hand supports the glass while the other works the towel. No liquid, no duplicate towel on the shoulder and no lettering on the cloth.



Soft terrier fur and capable hands

Short, fine mammal fur covers the forearms and hands, never feather shapes. Her fingers have a believable grip. Welcoming eyes, a proportional head and a fitted blouse complete the current character.

Unretouched details from the current presentation portrait. Crops reveal existing marks; they do not add resolution.

In the conversation.

One speaker. Every listener knows who has the floor.



Delivering the last word

Mouth open; attention toward the gentlemen, with the glass-polishing action retained.



Listening to Drew

Mouth closed; face and eyes turn toward Drew while her hands stay at their work.



Listening to Barclay

Mouth closed; attention shifts to Barclay. She remains the host of the room.

Facial acting crops from current Best Of masters, not retired concept sheets or newly invented full-body gestures.

How Abby speaks

- Speak with authority, delivered warmly.
- A proprietor's decision or practical rule makes a natural comic ending.
- She may address them as gentlemen; her line settles the matter rather than begging for agreement.

Relationships

Drew. She hears his polished observations without being overawed by them. Her practical answer brings the conversation back to the counter.

Barclay. She understands his wallet-level concerns, but she also knows what it takes to keep the lights on. Affection never makes her surrender the last word.

Keep consistent

- Behind the bar on the service side, standing higher than the seated gentlemen.
- A fitted light blouse with rolled sleeves, a dark skirt and no tail.
- A small proportional West Highland terrier head with bright, welcoming eyes.
- A plain towel in exactly one place, actively polishing an empty wine glass.
- Mouth open for her line; otherwise closed, looking at Drew or Barclay rather than the reader.